

COLLOCATIONS

Collocations are combinations of words which are usually used together.

Examples :-

- We don't **make** our homework, we **do** our homework.
- We don't **do** a mistake, we **make** a mistake.
- We don't **make** a party, we **have** a party. These are examples of collocations.

Certain nouns need a specific verb to express a certain sentence properly.

Given below is a list of such expressions :-

1. Ask

- Ask + a favour / a question

2. Break

- Break a bone/ your arm
- Break a code/a law/a promise/a record/the rules
- Break a leg/someone's heart
- Break a window
- Break free/ground/loose
- Break the news to someone
- Break the ice/the silence
- Break an engagement

3. Catch

- Catch a bus/ a train/a flight
- Catch a chill /a cold/a flu
- Catch a glimpse
- Catch sight of someone
- Catch someone's attention/someone's eye
- Catch your breath

4. Come

- Come close
- Come early/last/late/on time
- Come prepared/right back
- Come to a compromise/ a conclusion/a decision/a realization
- Come to a standstill / a stop / an agreement
- Come to an end/life
- Come to somebody's rescue/ terms with

5. Do

- Do a course/a deal/a favour
- Do a job/ a report/ research/a favour/sums/the paperwork/the drafting/the typing
- Do business/crosswords/damage
- Do exercise/experiments/ gymnastics

- Do harm/homework

- Do laundry/nothing/household work

- Do any household work eg-dishes, cleaning, ironing etc

- Do the minimum/the maximum

- Do your best/ your duty

- Do your hair/your makeup

6. Get

- Get a call /a clue/a chance/an opportunity

- Get a cold/ a headache/a fever/operated

- Get a degree/ a diploma

- Get a joke

- Get a letter (receive)/a shock

- Get angry/relaxed

- Get dark

- Get divorced/engaged/married/separated

- Get dressed/ undressed

- Get drunk/enthusiastic/excited/ frightened

- Get fired/ a job

- Get nowhere

- Get

old/cranky/hyper/oversensitive/emotional/tired/upset

- Get permission/pregnant/started

- Get stuck in something eg-a traffic jam/meeting/a situation

- Get the impression/ the message

7. Give

- Give a call (a ring, a buzz)

- Give a chance/ a choice

- Give a damn

- Give a hand/ a hug /a kiss

- Give a lecture /a speech/ a performance/ an advice/ an answer/ an example/ an idea/ an opinion

- Give birth/ credit

- Give evidence/ notice/ permission/ priority

- Give the impression

- Give a thought to something

8. Go

- Go abroad/ overseas
- Go astray/ bankrupt
- Go bad
- Go bald
- Go blind/ crazy/ deaf/ insane
- Go mad /angry
- Go missing
- Go on a picnic/ on a date
- Go on foot/ online/ out of business
- Go out of fashion
- Go smoothly
- Go to someplace eg- the beach/to the movie
- Go to war

9. Have

- Have a baby
- Have a backache/ a cold/ a headache
- Have a bad fall/ a bad temper/ a busy day/ a day off/ a depression/a hard time
- Have a bath/ a shave/a shower
- Have a birthday/ a business trip/a meeting/a presentation/an interview/a lecture/ a party/ a concert
- Have a bite
- Have a break/ a career/a goal/ a competition/a confrontation/ a fight/ a fit
- Have a chance
- Have a conversation/chat/ a dance
- Have a cup of tea/ coffee/
- Have lunch/ breakfast/ dinner/ soup/ a drink/ a meal
- Have a discussion/a dispute/ a doubt/ a dream/ a problem/ a quarrel
- Have a drill
- Have a feeling
- Have a goal/ a good time/a great weekend
- Have a haircut
- Have a holiday/ a break
- Have a laugh
- Have a look/ a massage
- Have a nightmare
- Have a passion for something. Eg- music, dance, etc.
- Have a plan
- Have a rest/ a nap/ a swim/ a session
- Have a safe journey/ a good day
- Have access (to)
- Have an accident/ an appointment with

- Have an argument
- Have an experience/ an excuse
- Have an idea
- Have faith/patience/hope/rest/sympathy
- Have self-esteem
- Have skills
- Have time
- Have trouble
- Have work

10. Keep

- Keep a diary
- Keep a promise/ a secret/ an appointment
- Keep calm/ control
- Keep in touch
- Keep quiet
- Keep records/ score
- Keep the change

11. Make

- Make a bed
- Make a cake/soup/ tea etc
- Make a call
- Make a choice/a comment/a complaint
- Make a confession /an admission
- Make a contract
- Make a deal/a decision
- Make a difference
- Make a discovery
- Make a fool of yourself
- Make a fortune/a fuss
- Make a habit/ a joke/ a list
- Make a living/a mess/a mistake
- Make a move
- Make a phone call/a point
- Make a prediction/a presentation
- Make a profit/a promise
- Make a reservation
- Make a sound/a speech
- Make a statement/a suggestion/ a bid
- Make a threat/ an agreement
- Make an appearance/ an appointment
- Make an attempt /an effort/an enquiry
- Make an exception/ an excuse
- Make an impression/an objection/an observation/an offer
- Make arrangements
- Make changes
- Make contact/ money

- Make noise/ peace
- Make plans/progress/an effort/ room/ sense
- Make someone angry/mad/happy/sad
- Make sure
- Make up/ up your mind
- Make war

12. Pay

- pay a bill/ a fine/ a penalty
- Pay a visit
- Pay attention
- Pay by credit card/ cash
- Pay interest
- Pay one's respects
- Pay someone a compliment
- Pay a visit

13. Save

- save electricity/energy/water/money/resources
- Save lives/one's strength/ time

14. Take

- Take a bite
- Take a bow/a break/a call
- Take a chance/a class
- Take a decision (make)
- Take a holiday/a lesson
- Take a look/a message
- Take a nap/ a step
- Take a number/a photo/ a photograph/ an autograph
- Take a picture
- Take a risk/a seat
- Take a shower (have)
- Take a taxi/bus/train/plane
- Take a while/ a minute/ five minutes
- Take action/ advantage /advice/ ages/ time
- Take an exam/ a test/ a course
- Take an opportunity
- Take care/charge/turns
- Take hostage/prisoner
- Take notes/ notice/place/pride in
- Take turns/your time